Before a Web app goes live, it is advisable to have it tested for any potential bugs. Various types of tests have to be made on the app to ensure that it performs as expected. This article covers the basic principles of Web app testing and gives the reader a glimpse of the top five open source apps in this space.

A huge discount at any online shopping portal invites us to look around for bargains. Having chosen a stylish T-shirt (with the '50 per cent OFF' tag), we click on 'Make Payment' only to find a message stating, 'Not in stock'.The slow working of web application under heavy load due to which stock got over by the time we could make payment disappoints us greatly. This would not have happened if the shopping portal had undergone proper load testing and performance testing. Such issues can be observed in other Web applications too, if their performance has not been evaluated and optimised properly.

Web applications follow the SDLC (software development life cycle) process right from the requirements-gathering phase to their development, and then on to the testing phase until the final application is ready for deployment in production. Testing is one of the most important phases of the SDLC. During this phase, the developed Web application is tested against the requirements mentioned in the SRS (software requirements specifications) document. Various types of testing, such as functional testing, integration testing, system testing and acceptance testing ensure that the application addresses all the specified needs. Load testing and performance testing are also performed by creating different virtual users to ensure that the application gives optimised performance under heavy load conditions, ensuring that it is not affected by any parameter. The important aspects that are considered during the evaluation of any Web application are:

1. Validation of the Web link, with which the Web app can be accessed by users, as well as of different links that help users to switch from one page of the Web app to the other.
2. The look and feel of various GUIs present in each tab of the Web app.
3. The functionality of different GUIs present in each tab of the Web app.
4. Database testing for the database accessed by the Web application in order to ensure that the data fetched by the application is valid and correct.
5. Performance of the Web app on different browsers.
6. Evaluation of the other performance parameters of the